Starter Apprenticeship Form
(Coach/Athlete)
Minnesota Swimming

Name: _____ Club: _____

Email: _____

Current and former USA Swimming coaches with 5+ years of experience, and **athletes** who have competed for **5+ years as 13-and-over swimmers**, bring valuable insights to the officiating community. Their background may allow for **accelerated training** toward becoming a Starter.

To support this transition, **experienced Referees** will guide you through two (2) apprentice sessions, covering all essential knowledge and skills needed to become a successful USA Swimming Starter.

When complete, scan the QR code to upload a photo of this application.

Prior to Beginning Apprenticing	**Date**
• Certified as a Stroke and Turn Official for a minimum of 3 months.	
• Officiated at least four (4) sessions at two (2) swim meets as a certified Stroke and Turn Official.	
Prior to Certification	**Date**
• Complete Starter Online Module in USA Swimming University	

Apprentice Sessions – complete a minimum of ***2 sessions***

	Date	**Meet Host**	**Print Names**	**Location**	**Ages**
1			Trainer:	☐ Home	☐ 12 & Under
			Meet Ref:	☐ Away	☐ 13 & Over
2			Trainer:	☐ Home	☐ 12 & Under
			Meet Ref:	☐ Away	☐ 13 & Over
Optional **3**			Trainer:	☐ Home	☐ 12 & Under
			Meet Ref:	☐ Away	☐ 13 & Over

Please briefly describe your swimming experience here. List club, high school, and/or collegiate experience and number of years.

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Performance Assessment (Completed by your trainer during your final apprentice session.)

Trainer Assessment Code	"Y" – demonstrated satisfactorily; "N" – demonstrated unsatisfactorily; "ND" – not demonstrated
	Arrives on time, prepared with necessary personal equipment and properly & professionally attired.
	Knows the rules for starting
	Demonstrate ability to start swimmers with a wide range of age and experience.
	Understands basic starting protocols and procedures (distance counting, OOF, etc.)
	Understands how to start swimmers with disabilities.
	Demonstrates the Start for a hearing impaired swimmer.
	Demonstrates both forward and backstroke starts.
	Understands how the starting system operates.
	Establishes a comfortable starting position on deck for both forward and back starts.
	Demonstrates ability to communicate and interact with the DR (positioning, inserting swimmers, etc...).
	Prepared and in position prior to each heat; comfortable holding microphone and securing cord.
	Delivers TYM calmly and with necessary volume.
	Shows PATIENCE before delivering TYM and starting signal.
	Understands the use of Other Commands.
	Understands and practices the False Start Protocol.
	Always gives the benefit of the doubt to the swimmer.
	Understands performance criteria as outlined in Starter Professional Document.
	Understands USA Swimming Safe Sport and MAAPP rules.

If any skill was not met or observed, write a development plan to help the Apprentice achieve their certification – e.g. additional apprentice sessions, re-watching a clinic, review the rulebook, etc. Discuss and provide the development plan to the Apprentice and send a copy to the Minnesota Swimming Officials Chair at mnoc.swim@gmail.com. The written development plan must be completed by the Apprentice **PRIOR** to certification being granted.

PRINT NAME of Trainer: _____ Date: _____

Signature of Trainer: _____

PRINT NAME of Meet Referee: _____ Date: _____

Signature of Meet Referee: _____